supposed to meet Gandhi in 1983 (in wake of him visiting India for medical treatment), from which he eventually backed out. Gandhi's refusal to connect Ghaffar Khan with Brezhnev was symbolic of India's restraint vis-à-vis Pakistan, even if its brief experiment of initiating a dialogue with Islamabad had failed.[54] Coupling this failing rapprochement with Islamabad was Moscow's generous credit line of US$ 1.63 billion payable after fifteen years (after a two year grace period) on a 2.5 per cent interest rate to an economically strained India,[55] and an arms-transfer package that included 100 T-72 tanks (with another 600 to be license-produced in India), five MiG 'Foxbat' aircrafts, and a huge number of fast-attack boats loaded with missiles, in May 1980.[56] In return, India was to remain silent on the Afghan question. The trick worked.[57]. Former Joint Director of the Intelligence Bureau, Maloy Krishna Dhar, who had recently taken charge of the counter-intelligence desk aimed at Soviet activities inside India was discouraged by the political leadership from 'penetrating' the KGB network.[58] Soviet intelligence agencies had been targeting Delhi-based Afghan refugees from diverse political backgrounds. Undermining such Soviet covert operations, he was told, 'was not compatible with the diplomatic initiative of India in Afghanistan'.[59] Concerned about New Delhi's 'lop-sided' Afghanistan policy of supporting the PDPA against the 'aspirations of the people of Afghanistan', Dhar advocated policy realignment in favour of the Mujahideen for two reasons. One, supporting the PDPA would anger Indian Muslims, and two, it would give the CIA and ISI a reason to 'incite troubles' in Kashmir and 'other strong Muslim pockets'. India, he argued to little effect, should not be seen 'as an enemy of the Islamist resistance in Afghanistan'.

Death of consensus

There is consensus among contemporary historians and policymakers that the coup in Afghanistan and the opportunity seen there by the Soviets, which led to the invasion, precipitated the larger US intervention. Though true in retrospect, at that time, at least among Indian policymaking corridors, it was seen as a 'chicken-and-egg' problem, which led to a policy compromise. Did increasing US and Pakistani interference in domestic Afghan affairs lead to the Soviet